



Localisation

Localise an Application Menu

In this article, let us focus on localising an application by picking a typing tutor called Klavaro as an example. It is simple and requires to be localised for most Indian languages. Please note that the author has tried the tasks mentioned in this article on Ubuntu 12.04 with Telugu locale and you may need to adapt the instructions suitably for your locale/language of interest.

As Klavaro is not part of the default installation disk, it needs to be installed manually. Please select Ubuntu Software Centre, search for Klavaro and install it—or in a terminal, run `sudo apt-get install klavaro`.

For a localiser, it is important to explore the application to understand its functioning, and review how menus appear. The first screen you see when you run it is shown in Figure 1. You will notice that Klavaro has a simple menu structure at the bottom part of the screen. In the top portion, you will find a few big buttons, which lead to the basic steps of how to use the program. As these are examples of help files, containing text about how to use the application, I will cover such localisation for them in a future article.

The first thing to do is to click 'About' to learn more about the application. From this, you will find the version number and a link to the site (<http://klavaro.sourceforge.net/>) where code and other information is available. On that site, you will find information about localisation (see Figure 2) and also the platforms or environments in which the localisation is coordinated. From the Web page, we learn that it uses Gettext for i18n and Translation Project (<http://translationproject.org/>) as the platform for i10n.

One also finds Poedit as part of the sample tools suggested for localisation, so let's use it to localise this package. Take a moment to check the status of localisation for your language

of interest at the Translation Project. You may find that it is either not translated, is partially done or is fully translated. If it is not translated, you can download the *.pot* file from the package host site or from the Translation Project site, and start localisation. In case you find the translation completed for your language, you can review the localised application and identify any improvements that are needed. Then you can download the current localisation file (*.po*) from the Translation Project, and continue with the following process, to improve it.

Poedit

Poedit needs to be installed manually; a simple `sudo apt-get install poedit` will do it. Run Poedit and you will be prompted to enter a few details that will be useful as you work with the tool—your user name, email ID, etc. If you are already using Ubuntu with your locale, you can get the benefit of generating the translation memory from your current set-up—select the 'Translation Memory' tab in Preferences and add your language; then select *Generate Database*. A screen (Figure 4) with suggested paths of localisation catalogues will be shown. If you continue, all *.mo* files in those directories will be read, and a translation memory database will be created.

Poedit has three panes: the top one shows the messages catalogue (both the source language message in English, and the target language message, if already translated),